community was close-knit, so much so that in one local cricket match in Bradford in 2001 all twenty-two players on the field were Patels.[72] The scorekeeper, himself a Patel, had the fairly amusing job of recording a scoreboard on the lines of Patel c. Patel b. Patel, Patel b. Patel, Patel run-out Patel, and so on.

In the US, the Patels scored big in motels. Starting from just two motels in the 1950s, the Patels comprised over half of all the moteliers in the US by the end of the 20th century.[73] They would start by purchasing a run-down motel, renovate it and provide professional hospitality services. Patidar women would also participate in this business as the worksite was the same place as their home. Children would grow up to extend business lines or venture into other businesses in the US, especially those that catered to the requirements of high-skilled Indian professional migrants. Thus, the Gujaratis enjoyed commercial success in the US just like they had in East Africa and India.

In 2014, sixteen Gujaratis ranked among India's hundred most rich business leaders, second only to the Marwaris.[74] More significantly, they figure on the rich lists of many countries other than India. This has been possible due to the migration of Gujarati merchants and capital over centuries. This migration was gradual, transnational and widespread across communities and sectors. The image of a Gujarati family, sitting on a *chattai* and enjoying khakra practically anywhere in the world, including airports, is a sight to behold. The chances are high that they belong to a long line of illustrious entrepreneurs who call the world their home.

The Muslim Merchants

The Islamic faith first arrived in south India through trade and forged close and enduring connections along the west coast. Dating back to 7th century CE, the Moplah Muslims of Kerala arguably reflect the earliest of these connections. Today, they constitute a major share of the total number of Muslims in Kerala, who in turn constitute about a quarter of the state's population and are highly concentrated around Kozhikode, earlier called